



Mrs. Floyd LaFarlette Once Liked Noise Of Bustling City -- Now Coquille

A woman who speaks glowingly and at length about the beauty of the Coquille Valley and the friendliness of its residents is Mrs. Floyd LaFarlette, one of the efficient waitresses at the Coquille Hotel's coffee shop.

Mrs. LaFarlette, better known as Raye, first came to Coos county on a vacation trip with her husband and children in 1944. They were so impressed with the splendors of the valley that they decided to return to their home in Chicago, Ill., sell their rooming house business and move to Coquille.

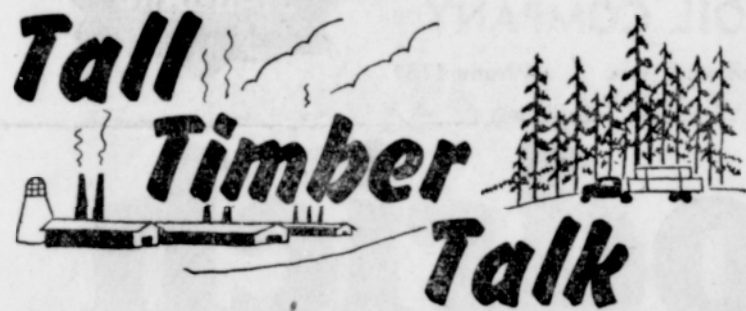
Raye says that at first she missed the bustling city, but a trip back there last year convinced her that Coquille is the only place to live.

She has worked for several years at the hotel and says that "The best part of it is that each person is an individual and no two are alike. It's interesting and certainly never monotonous."

As for the folks here, well, Raye sums it up by saying that Coquille is one place where your neighbors are always willing to lend a helping hand. "And you just don't find such friendliness in a large city."

She and her husband, who works at Coos Bay Lumber Company, and their two daughters, Carolyn 15, and Sheila 9, enjoy going for long drives and on picnics.

The LaFarlette's decision to move to Coquille 10 years ago has been a happy one for them and for the town.



It's time again for school budgets and there's not an easy head that wears the crown of budgeting.

Despite the fact that Oregon lags California and Washington in salaries to teachers, Oregon is still in the first ten of the U. S. states, and that is painful to many a taxpayer both big and small in these days of higher and higher taxes.

No one seriously questions the fact that teachers should receive pay commensurate with their training and professional standards.

No one wants to underpay them. The simple economics fact is if teacher salaries are to go up, then some other tax supported group is going to have to take a cut.

So far, no tax levying body has ever wanted to take a cut in its budget.

And headaches will continue again this year.

A ride through the countryside will show you Coos county farms looking mighty good these spring days. Paint has been used. Fences are thrifty. The stock is fat and the lambs fine. A good sign that Coos farmers are going to slug it out and get down to real farming practices in 1954.

One of the largest crowds to use the Community building was that of the election boards last week. County Clerk Georgianna Vaughan set the meeting to help new board members learn something of the work before the actual work started in May. And the response was wonderful. Who says American citizens aren't responsible? We say a bouquet goes to all the board members who arrived for tutelage and to County Clerk Vaughan and D. A. John Pickett for their work in behalf of good government. (Pickett gave a talk on the board work.)

How things change? Not so long ago you had to look up a car salesman to buy a car. Now they come to see you. And we actually "borrowed" a car on Sunday from Salesmen who are now out looking on Sundays for people who might like a new car. All kidding.

Height of fertility . . . city crew painting yellow stripes on crosswalks while cars ran across it and when the men had gone, practically all the paint was gone too.

A big thrill to the local people Friday night when Bill Head walked down the street. He was home for a weekend from the Vets hospital. Will be back up there two months and then home.

Bill says he and everyone else read The Sentinel from front page to back, and all the words in it.

Something about hospitals is how much you miss your home town. Andy Anderson at the Salem T. B. hotel and George Stratton at The Dalles could stand a few letters.

County Officials Hear Budget Needs

County Judge James Harrison met Monday night with other county department heads to discuss budgetary needs of county departments for the coming year.

Purpose of the evening session was to gain ideas of financial requirements in preparation for the Budget Committee meeting in May.

Rainfall Down

February rainfall recorded at the CAA weather station at the North Bend airport totaled only 5.6 inches during the month. This was 3 inches under the 1953 February record.

No Objections Filed Against Street Re-naming

Unless a last-minute rapid fire movement develops against the city ordinance to re-name and re-number the city streets of Coquille, the ordinance adopted three weeks ago by the city council will become law on Thursday morning at 12:01.

The street re-naming and re-numbering, one of the most controversial subjects since the bond issue to build a modern filter plant for the water system was first proposed by the city planning commission under the leadership of President Dave Biegener.

The plan, which included a complete study of the present city limits and all areas adjacent to town was done at the specific request of the city council and Mayor Donald Farr.

Work was started. The study was made. Advisory bodies called in for consultation.

Plans and re-numbering of other towns were brought together for the planning commission.

The Oregon League of Cities was asked for advice. And many hours of work went into the project.

It was first proposed to the city council a year ago.

And it was dismissed.

Brought up again, it became the focal spot for a petition carrying some two hundred names asking that it not be adopted. The council countered with the inclusion of a straw ballot at a regular city budget election at which time the street changing measure lost out by a small number of votes.

The issue then lay dormant until it was revived by a councilman and brought forth again. This time the city council voted in favor of the measure with no dissenting votes. Only one councilman, Clarence Barton, was absent from the meeting, and he was called to Portland on business affairs. He however, had requested that his negative vote be recorded before he left Coquille.

According to Tallant Greenough, Coquille city attorney, unless a petition, correctly and legally made out and signed, is filed by midnight of next Wednesday, the new city ordinance will become law on Thursday, March 18th.

And everyone in Coquille will have a new address without having to move one foot.

Coquille Valley Sentinel

VOL. L. NO. 9

COQUILLE, OREGON, Thursday, March 11, 1954

16 PAGES

10 Cents Per Copy

More Jobs Noted In S. W. Oregon During February

Definite evidence of improvement in the labor market area of Coos, Curry and Western Douglas counties was noted in February. Many temporarily laid off employees were recalled while others found openings with firms again hiring needed replacements or expanding winter crews. The clear weather near the end of the month was largely responsible for the increase in job openings.

During the week ending February 13, 1954, 1,117 benefit payments were made by the Coos Bay local office. 729 (62%) had last been employed in the logging industry, 159 (13%) in trade and 109 (9%) in construction. Smaller groups included forest and fishing 19, food processing 28, other manufacturing 15, transportation and utilities 46, finance and miscellaneous 72. These figures indicate the necessity of developing our lumber industry to include year around manufacturing processes to utilize the labor supply throughout the year. The local office made 98 replacements during the month, compared to 70 in January and 65 in February, 1953.

The outlook is excellent for the construction industry during the next six months with a number of large school buildings planned, and scheduled to begin soon, as well as continuing road projects. The lumber industry is expected to maintain full production as soon as weather conditions permit with saw logs at a premium at the present time. Retail establishments note increased volume of sales during the past few weeks as purchasing power has increased. Employment throughout the area should expand rapidly during the next 60 days.

2,150 are estimated to be unemployed at the end of February compared to 2,530 a month earlier. Of these 525 are women. New claims dropped from 1,045 in January to 533 during the past month although there was no decrease in total weeks claimed. Initial claims were nearly identical with last year, and continued claims were running 20% higher.

Total employment is expected to closely parallel that of last spring and summer if present trends continue. The amount of immigration will probably be the key to whether a surplus or shortage of help will exist during the peak summer months.

The Coos Bay office of the Oregon State Employment is carrying on an extensive aptitude testing program in the high schools of the area. The results of these tests indicate that there will be a good supply of unusually well qualified young people graduating this year. Don't overlook this group when planning your future requirements as many of them will be looking for permanent positions or summer work.



A GIRL SCOUT TRIO—One of the Scoutmaster families in Coquille is the LeRoy Swinney family shown above. Janet Swinney, left, is an active member of the Senior Girl Scouts; LeRoy Swinney is the Troop committee leader, and Mrs. Swinney, after serving as president of the Girl Scout Council, is now a troop leader. (Sentinel Photo)

German Journalist Coming To City

Coquille To Be Host To Prominent European Editor Who Is Learning About U. S. Under Gov't. Sponsorship

Coquille and the Coquille Valley will be host to a prominent German newspaperman the week of March 14 to 19 when Dr. Franz Oexle of Konstanz, Germany, works on The Coquille Valley Sentinel as a guest editor and reporter.

Oexle is sent to Coquille to learn about a modern small rural town and area. He is under the auspices of the U. S. State department, and while here will speak to various clubs and groups on modern Germany today.

Franz Oexle, pronounced, approximately, "ex-lee", 32, is a member of the editorial staff of the Konstanz Sudkurier (South Messenger), on the Lake of Konstanz between the German-Swiss border.

Oexle, the oldest of the group of five German newspapermen with whom he came to the United States, is responsible for writing, editing and arranging the news of local communities served by his paper. His position is similar to that of an American city editor.

A native of Uberlingen, he attended public schools there and later studied at the Universities of Tubingen, Basle and Freiburg, and received the degree of doctor of philosophy (in German literature) at Freiburg in 1951.

German Army Veteran

A veteran of the German army, he served from 1941 until his capture by American troops in 1945. Earlier, he participated in the Russian campaign of 1942-44, and was with troops which made the deepest penetration into Russia in the Caucasus area. He was one of the few German troops to get out of the Crimea area in 1944, when a transfer took him back to Germany just before a Russian attack cut off his unit. He later served on the western front.

Oexle is obviously fond of the Black Forest area of Germany from which he comes. He calls it "the romantic part" of Germany. He is engaged to a Swiss girl, and frequently visits her across the border, which is only a few blocks from his office.

At the University of Oregon he has taken varied studies in addition to those in the School of Journalism, which is his sponsor during his stay. The program, which includes four other young German newspapermen, is administered by Gordon A. Sabine, dean of the School of Journalism, for the State Department.

The five Germans arrived in the United States aboard the SS Andra Doria last September 9, where they were met by Eric Allen, Jr., city editor of the Medford (Oregon) Mail Tribune, who took a leave of absence from his paper to serve as coordinator for their program.

See The United States

After several days in New York, where they visited a number of newspaper and magazine offices, and other attractions, they visited Washington, D. C., for two days, and then came west by way of Chicago and Portland. All have travelled extensively on the Pacific coast, and enroute home will have an opportunity to see much of the American South.

The program, only one of its kind in the United States this year, is a part of the Exchange of Persons program of the U. S. State Department, which has brought some 30,000 persons to America in 1953-54 alone. Of the total, about 8,000 are from Germany. The program is financed in large part by the sale of surplus war materials in Europe.

The five newspapermen visiting Oregon were selected for the trip by the office of the U. S. High Commissioner in Germany on the basis of ability, potential leadership and influence, and the ability to speak English.

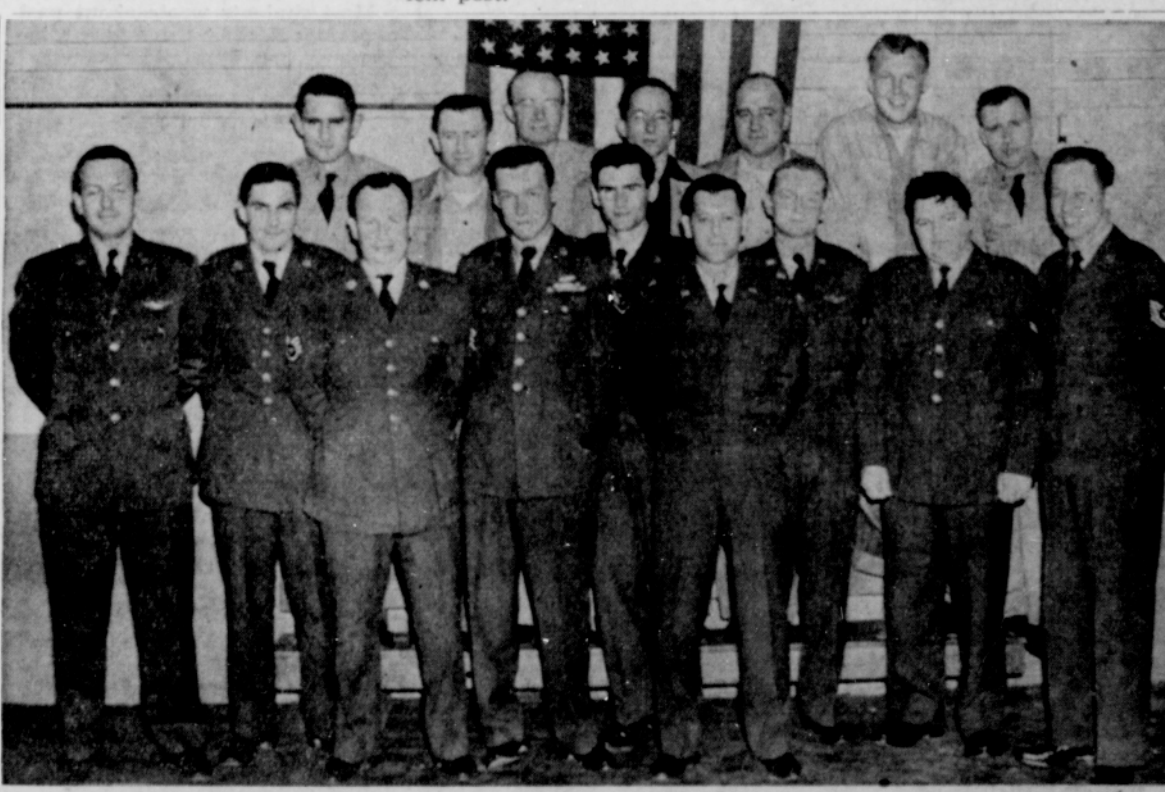
John J. Pickett Speaks At Meet

John J. Pickett, district attorney, spoke to members of the county election boards when they met last Thursday at the community building.

He explained their duties in relation to the statutes.

Georgianna Vaughan, county clerk, outlined the procedures that the election boards are to follow during the election.

Mr. and Mrs. Ted Foss left Coquille recently for a vacation trip in California.



IN RESERVE—Members of Coquille's Air Reserve unit and visitors pose for a group picture. Shown from left to right, front row: Capt. Donald Hemingway, group liaison officer stationed at Medford; A/IC Loran Holland; Staff Sgt. Eddie Paget; Staff Sgt. Ernest Benham; A/IC Bill Moore; Maj. "Pete" Petre, flight commander; 1st Lt. Russell Kohler; Cpt. Jack Nichols; Sgt. L. R. Patterson, liaison sergeant; Back row: 1st Lt. Martin Kranek, Maj. Rex Brudos; 1st Lt. Kenneth R. Vaughn; Staff Sgt. Gene Vaughn; Cpl. Pete Lanser; PFC Jim Lindgren; 1st Lt. Hershel Thoma. (Sentinel Photo)

Coquille Has Fly Boys

Air Reserve Squadron Members Take Training And Plan Procedures In Case U. S. Is Called Upon For War

By LARRY HOBART

A meat cutter, a real estate dealer, and a mill employee sat around a table in the basement of the Coquille Labor Temple one night last month and listened to a telephone repair man describe the problems of activating an Air Force base in the event of war.

Despite their diverse occupations, the four men, part of a group of 14, had one thing in common: They all formerly served on active duty with the United States Air Force and are presently maintaining that connection through the Volunteer Air Reserve.

Known officially as Flight C, 9415 Squadron, 9091 Group of the 4th Air Force, Coquille's air reserve unit was established in May, 1952. There were five active members. Today there are 14.

Air reserve members receive no pay for attending their two meetings each month. However, point credit toward retirement and pro-

motion are given. The "point system" works like this: Each member receives one point for attendance at a meeting. He can gain additional points for presenting training lectures, signing up new members or donating blood to the Red Cross. In order to have a "good year" (a year which counts toward retirement) a man must earn 35 points. Retirement pay, which begins at the end of 20 or 30 years of service, is based upon the number of "good years" plus the number of years of active duty a man has served. Retirement pay may run as high as 75 per cent of the serviceman's base pay while on active duty.

Points count toward promotion, too. During the past year, four airmen and one officer received advancements.

What is the purpose of the air reserve? "Pete" Petre, local real estate man and commander of the local reserve unit, sums it up as "training to maintain a high

standard of knowledge and efficiency; to keep up with advancements in the Air Force so that in event of an emergency we may resume our duties with a minimum of confusion."

Semi-prepared training kits are received by the reserve unit for each meeting. The kits include lecture material which can be presented by reserve members. Occasional training movies are also presented at the evening meetings. Correspondence courses, which aid individual promotion, are also available.

Coquille's reserve unit has one of the best attendance records in the 4th Air Force.

Meetings are not all cut and dried. Over the coffee and donuts at the end of the lecture program, talk swings to stories of the campaigns in Europe and the South Pacific . . . stories told by men who ought to know. They were there.

National 4-H Week Being Observed

Coos county 4-H chapters were busy this week holding observances for the National 4-H week. Proclamations by both President Eisenhower and Gov. Paul Patterson of Oregon were received by the local clubs, according to Walt Schroeder, 4-H agent for Coos.

Special celebrations have been set throughout the county and exhibits are set up in various stores in the cities of the area.

A group of special 4-H stories are being written for publication in The Sentinel next week.

ELECT NEW OFFICERS

New officers of the Coquille Valley Country club will be elected at a meeting scheduled for 8 p. m. Tuesday. All members are requested to attend.

Television System Eyed For Coquille

A group of Coquille men are conducting research behind a locked door on a possible community antenna system for television reception in the city, it was learned today by The Sentinel.

The men who are well-versed in the science of electronics, radio and television from past experi-

ence, have been working out the problems of good TV reception in Coquille. They have also been attempting new systems for a community antenna set-up which would be used to give TV to local residents on a subscriber basis similar to paying for telephone or other utilities.

Basis for the research is the fact that Coquille is in a dead spot at the present time except for a co-axial cable which would cost upwards to \$300,000. The men who are watching the Thorntons research at Coos Bay feel that they may be developing a plan here that would be more satisfactory,

however, they do not know, they said.

Community networks are not new and in the East they have been highly successful. Some valley areas in Pennsylvania have thousands of subscribers to the TV service.

Because the research is definitely in the infant stage, the Co-

quille group requested that their names not be used in a news release.

"However," said one, "the minute we have it licked we'll give you the dope."

In the meantime television, what with the Thorntons' booster station plan, and the present Coquille set-up, is drawing near.

quille group requested that their names not be used in a news release.

"However," said one, "the minute we have it licked we'll give you the dope."

In the meantime television, what with the Thorntons' booster station plan, and the present Coquille set-up, is drawing near.